

Chapter 12

Instructor's Manual

This chapter covers:

- A discussion of the complex relationship between race, ethnicity, class, and language use in Hawai'i
- The difference between a pidgin and a creole
- Hawai'ian Creole English, the linguistic diversity of Hawai'i, attitudes about Hawai'ian Creole English, and linguistic discrimination in Hawai'i
- A description of the language policies used for the educational system in Hawai'i
- An analysis of a 1983 news report on Hawai'ian Creole English that illustrates the steps of the language subordination process

Sample answers to the questions from the text and the website

From the textbook

1. *Is Hawai'ian Creole a language? Be prepared to argue both sides.*

Sample answer: If one were to argue that HCE was a separate language from English, one could point out that there are differences in vocabulary, grammar, and pronunciation between HCE and English. In addition, some varieties of HCE would be very difficult for English speakers who were unfamiliar with HCE to understand. However, one could also argue that HCE is a dialect of English because much of the vocabulary is shared since English was a major contributing language to HCE. In addition, some varieties of HCE are very similar to other varieties of English and would be easily understood by English speakers who were unfamiliar with HCE.

2. *First, consider this short excerpt from Lois-Ann Yamanaka's novel, Wild Meat and the Bully Burgers (1996:13).*

But I can't talk the way he wants me to. I cannot make it sound his way, unless I'm playing pretend-talk haole. I can make my words straight, that's pretty easy if I concentrate real hard. But the sound, the sound from my mouth, if I let it rip right out the lips, my words will always come out like home.

Then read Pennybacker's article (March 1, 1999) on Lois-Ann Kamanaka's satirical novels set in the Hawai'ian Islands, and written in Pidgin:

Pennybacker, Mindy. "What Boddah You?: The Authenticity Debate (Lois-Ann Yamanaka)." The Nation. <http://www.thenation.com/article/what-boddah-you-authenticity-debate>

Who objected to Yamanaka's books, and on what basis? Was censorship called for?

Sample answer: The Association for Asian American Studies objected to Yamanaka's books because the books contained negative stereotypes about Filipino men. I do not think censorship was called for because I think authors have the right to explore controversial themes in their books. I agree with the AAAS that it would have been nice if Yamanaka had made it clearer that her books were not endorsing those stereotypes in order to help combat them, but since Yamanaka is exploring racial tensions as a theme in her book, it seems reasonable that some characters will hold such racial stereotypes.

3. Reconsider Lois-Ann Yamanaka's satirical novels set in the Hawai'ian Islands as well as Pennybacker's article on Yamanaka's work (March 1, 1999), Talmy (2010) and The Southern Poverty Law Center's report called "Prejudice in Paradise" which can be found here: <http://www.splcenter.org/get-informed/intelligence-report/browse-all-issues/2009/fall/prejudice-in-paradise>. With more context and historical background, do your opinions about Yamanaka's work change? In what way?

Sample answer: After getting more context and historical background on racism in Hawai'i, I feel more strongly that it would be ideal for her work to not just explore racist themes but more actively work to help eliminate negative stereotypes about various ethnic groups living in Hawai'i.

From the website

Audio

*1. Listen to the samples of HCE and AAVE. Chapter 12 discusses research done by Marlow and Giles (2008) which discusses how many people believe that *SAE should be used in business and formal situations rather than HCE. It was noted that the discussion of when to use HCE was similar to research on attitudes about when AAVE should be used. Why do you think these similarities exist in the language attitudes of speakers of AAVE and HCE?*

Sample answer: I think that HCE and AAVE are discussed in similar ways because they are both subordinated language varieties that are tied to racial or ethnic groups and they are both considered by many non-linguists to be "broken" English rather than the systematic, rule-governed, expressive language varieties they are. Since these language varieties are stigmatized, HCE and AAVE speakers think that *SAE should be used in formal situations so their ideas will be taken seriously by people who devalue HCE and AAVE.

2. Listen to the samples of English spoken with a Filipino accent and revisit the information in the case of Manuel Fragante, the Filipino man who was not hired by the DMV in Hawai'i because of his accent. Evaluate the DMV's motivation for not hiring Fragante – based on the information about the case provided in Chapters 9 and 12, what do you think the real reason was behind the DMV's decision?

Sample answer: Based on what I have read in this book about accent discrimination in general, I would argue that Fragante was likely not hired because the interviewers were prejudiced against people who sound like Fragante – Filipinos – rather than his individual accent. In addition, after

reading the discussion of Japanese-Filipino relations in Hawai'i described in Chapter 12, I am more certain that Fragante was not hired because he sounded Filipino, not because his accent was unintelligible (especially since he later got a job that required him to conduct phone interviews).

3. Listen to the samples of the language varieties mentioned in Chapter 12 and examine the following quote from page 242:

We want the children of the United States to have a thorough command of English, but it is more than that. We are not satisfied with English as it lives and breathes, English with a Cuban accent, the English spoken off the coast of South Carolina, or Hawai'i Creole English. We want the right English, the one correct English.

Why do you think that so many people want everyone to speak the "right" English? Why would English with a Cuban accent, the English spoken off the coast of South Carolina, or Hawai'i Creole English not be considered the one "right" English?

Sample answer: I think many people are obsessed with one homogenous variety of English because 1) they don't understand that all language varieties are equally systematic and expressive so there really is no "right" English and 2) they think that if we all sound the same that it will minimize social problems like the inequity present in education, employment, etc. I think that English with a Cuban accent, the English spoken off the coast of South Carolina, and HCE are not considered the one "right" English because these language varieties are not spoken by the people who have the most power in the United States. In my opinion, the one "right" language variety will be the one spoken by the most powerful people because they are in position to control the language subordination process.

Video

"Ha Kim Wi Tawk Pidgin Yet?" Parts 1–4

A student project video from the Wai'anea High School on Oahu

http://www1.teachertube.com/viewVideo.php?video_id=152909

http://www1.teachertube.com/viewVideo.php?video_id=154041

http://www1.teachertube.com/viewVideo.php?video_id=154043

http://www1.teachertube.com/viewVideo.php?video_id=152962

1. What language ideologies about Hawai'ian Creole English and *SAE are expressed in these videos?

Sample answer: There are two primary language ideologies that are apparent in these videos. One language ideology considers HCE to be a substandard language variety – nothing more than "broken" *SAE. Several adults interviewed in these videos expressed this opinion. The other takes pride in HCE as a language variety that signals a local identity, ethnic identity, community, and family. An interesting example related to this particular language ideology was the high school student in the fourth video who said that he can't speak *SAE in school or else his classmates would look down on him for not using HCE. Some of the speakers interviewed in these videos seem to hold both ideologies simultaneously, which supports Marlow and Giles'

(2008) work exploring when and why Hawai'ians choose HCE or SAE (see p. 238–39 for a discussion of this research).

Suggested activities and discussion questions

1. Examine the following quote from Chapter 12 (p. 235):

Issues of authenticity and authority have everything to do with who may call themselves Hawai'ian and who can claim to be Kanaka 'Oiwī or Kanaka Maoli; that is, native Hawai'ian (Pennybacker March 1, 1999).

Ask the students if there are similarly complex issues of authenticity and authority in any communities in which they are a part. If so, what role does language play in claiming group membership?

2. Consider the following quote discussing the Board of Education's proposal to ban Hawai'i Creole English from schools (p. 241):

The 1987 proposal by the school board, then, would have taken this well-established language spoken natively by more than half a million people and banned it from the school system. Why was this language, of all the many languages spoken in Hawai'i, singled out for exclusion? While in Arizona legislatures debate bilingual education for native speakers of Apache and Spanish, in Hawai'i it occurs to the school board to ban a language which, on one end of the continuum, is mutually intelligible with English. Why?

What answer would your students give to answer the question of why HCE would be singled out even though some varieties of HCE are mutually intelligible with English?

3. Ask your students to discuss the proposal to ban HCE from schools in 1987. What arguments can they think of to support or oppose the proposal? Ask them to connect these arguments to linguistic research if possible.

4. To enhance discussion of this chapter, please visit the companion website and check out the audio and video clips available for use in your classroom.